

Immigration SaaS Viability Report

Helping U.S. Latino immigrants whose visa status is not up-to-date or no longer compliant with USCIS / CBP rules.

Prepared for	Cesar (founder)
Co-founders	2x Brazilian, expats in AU + US
Scope	U.S. Latino diaspora · PT + ES first · EN secondary
Anchor ICP	Persona A — Brazilian, 34, FL, pending I-539
Date	May 2026
Verdict	GO — disciplined wedge, regulated launch

Mixed-method analysis: 2026 immigration enforcement data, USCIS adjudication trends, competitive landscape (YC-backed AI startups, incumbents, attorney market), UPL regulatory scan, and pricing benchmarks. All figures cited.

Executive Summary

Delivered in STAR format. Read in 90 seconds.

Situation

Trump 2.0 has unleashed the largest immigration enforcement build-out in U.S. history (**\$170.1B** appropriated, July 2025). USCIS now sits on a record **~12 million pending cases**. Denial rates for I-485 (green card) rose **+21% YoY** while approvals fell **-10.5%**. EAD validity was cut from 5 years to 18 months. The Latino immigrant population (**22.7M**) — and the ~14M unauthorized residents nationally — are living through the most intense compliance pressure in a generation.

Task

Decide whether to build a SaaS that helps Latino immigrants whose status is not up-to-date or no longer compliant — without being a law firm, without committing UPL, and without becoming a target of either state bars or DOJ. Output: market analysis, SWOT, verdict, and recommended business model.

Action

We sized the addressable market from DHS overstay data, Pew demographic data, and USCIS backlog reports; mapped 8 competitors across price and visa-scope; pressure-tested the model against UPL law (DoNotPay precedent, CA \$100K bond, NC software carve-out, DOJ R&A; program); and benchmarked unit economics against attorney pricing (\$3K–\$10K per case) and incumbent SaaS (\$500–\$1,200).

Result

Weighted viability score: 7.48 / 10 → GO. Recommended wedge: **B1/B2 → F1 change-of-status candidates in Florida, Texas, New Jersey, Massachusetts**, PT/ES-first, anchored by Persona A. Business model: **three-tier subscription** (\$9/\$29/mo) with a **\$1,499 attorney-led Concierge filing**, distributed through SEVP schools, WhatsApp/IG communities, and a vetted attorney partner network. **Bootstrap the first 1,500 users; raise pre-seed only after PMF.**

Anchor Persona — "Persona A"

Persona A is a real, anonymized case used as the design anchor. Millions of variants of this person exist across the U.S. Latino diaspora.

Anchor ICP — millions of variants exist across U.S. Latino diaspora



PERSONA A — "The Pending Overstayer"

Brazilian · 34 · Broward County, FL · 3 years in U.S.

Current Status: B1/B2 with pending 2nd I-539 extension (authorized stay)

Vulnerability: Likely unauthorized work via own U.S. LLC → fraud risk

Goal: F1 change of status → CPT/OPT → H1B → green card → citizenship

Will NOT do: Return to Brazil for consular processing

Pays today: \$3,500-10,000 to attorneys; uses WhatsApp groups for info

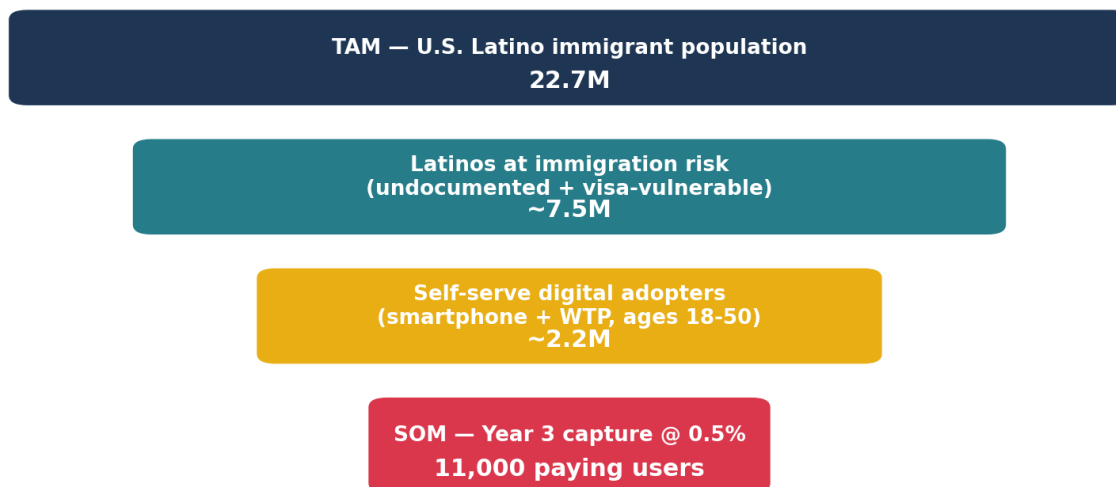
Speaks: Portuguese (native), English (functional)

Why Persona A is the right anchor: she/he sits at the intersection of (1) **active legal anxiety** — pending I-539, fragile authorized stay, (2) **high willingness to pay** — already spent thousands on attorneys, (3) **self-inflicted vulnerability** — likely unauthorized work via own LLC, (4) **aspirational pathway** — wants to go F1 → CPT/OPT → H1B → green card, and (5) **language-underserved** — Portuguese-native, with English a working second language. Every product feature in this report can be stress-tested against her case.

1. Market Analysis

Market Sizing — TAM / SAM / SOM

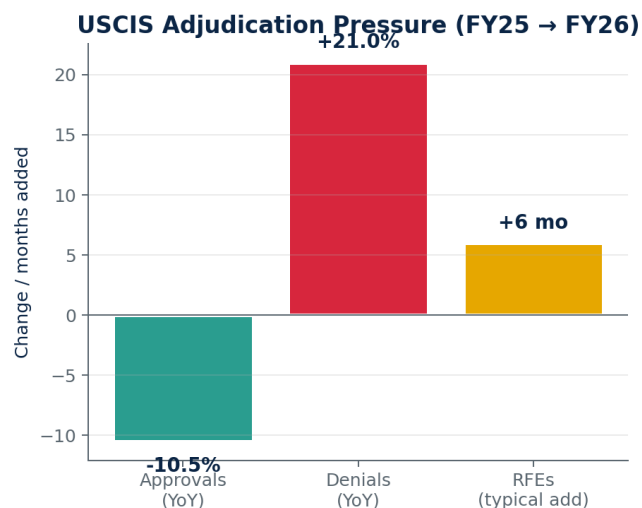
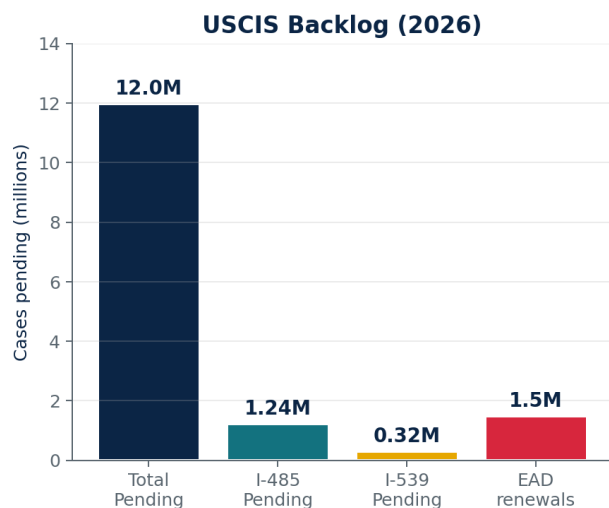
Market Sizing Funnel — Latino Immigration SaaS (U.S.)



SOM ARPU @ 360/yr(blended) → 4.0M ARR by year 3

TAM: 22.7M Hispanic immigrants in the U.S. (Pew 2024). **SAM:** ~7.5M immediately at-risk — the 14M unauthorized population × ~53% Latino share, plus visa-vulnerable status holders. **SOM:** ~2.2M digital-adopter Latinos in the addressable age band with willingness to pay for self-serve immigration help. Capturing 0.5% in three years yields ~11,000 paying subscribers at a blended ARPU of \$360/yr — ~\$4.0M ARR. Aggressive but not heroic.

Demand Pressure — Why now



USCIS sits on ~12M pending cases. I-485 (adjustment of status) pending grew **15.5% in nine months**, with approvals down **10.5%** and denials up **21%** year-over-year. Cases that draw an RFE add **4–8 months**. The structural backlog plus tighter adjudication = more anxiety, more confusion, more paid help — exactly the conditions a compliance SaaS feeds on.

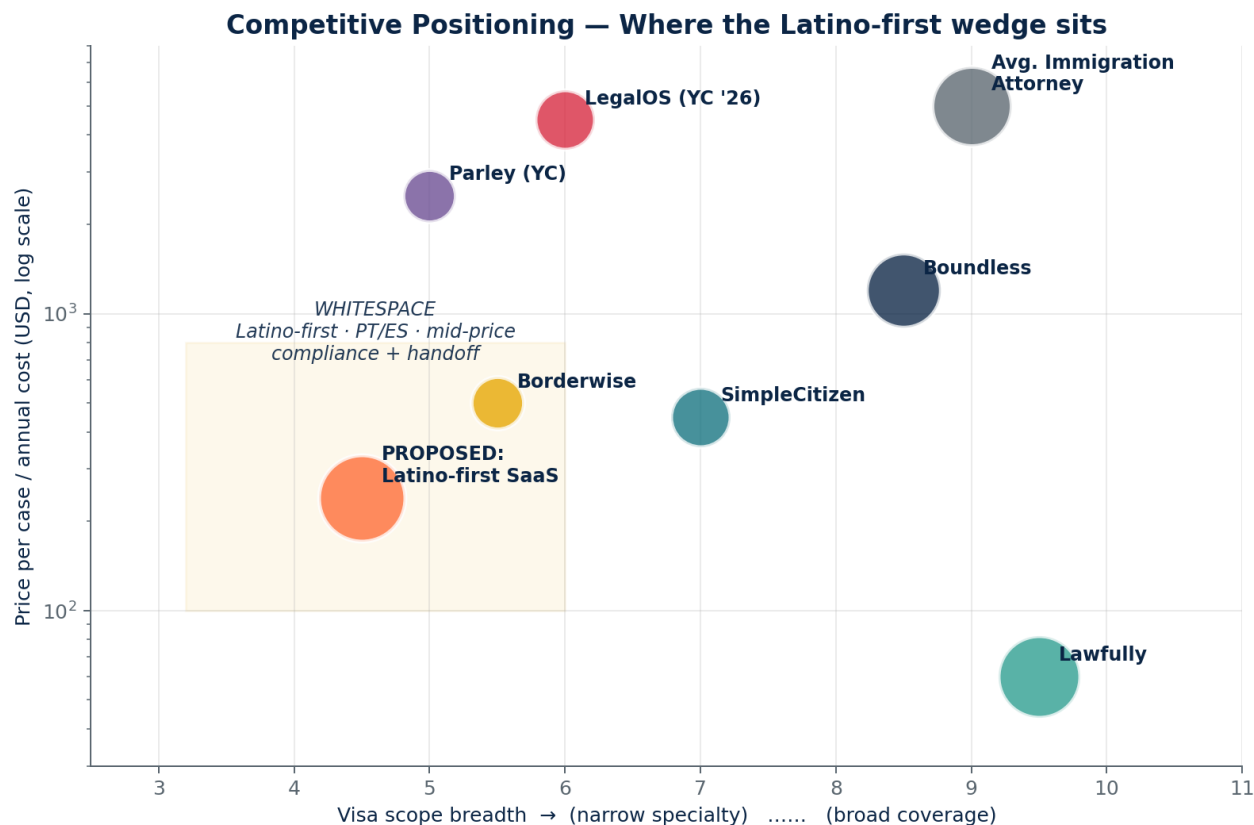
Top 3 segments (ranked)

#	Segment	Size (est.)	Pain	WTP	Reach
1	B1/B2 → F1 change-of-status (Latino, FL/TX/NJ/MA)	~250K active	Very High	\$300–500/yr + \$1,500 filing	Schools, WhatsApp
2	Out-of-status 'pending-too-long' overstayers	~500K	Critical	\$200/yr (panic-driven)	Community orgs, IG
3	Employment-based applicants with pending I-485/EAD renewals	~1.2M pending	High	\$400/yr	Employer HR, churches

Pricing benchmarks (what they pay today)

Service	Today's price	What you get
Immigration attorney (I-485)	\$3,000 – \$10,000	Full filing + representation
Immigration attorney (I-539)	\$1,500 – \$3,500	Form prep + advice
Boundless	\$1,200/yr	Marriage GC focus, mostly broad family-based
SimpleCitizen	\$449 / case	Form prep, no attorney included
Borderwise	~\$500 flat	Form prep; PWYC for DACA
Lawfully (case tracker)	Free + premium consults	USCIS case status + community
LegalOS (YC W26)	~\$4,500/case	AI-drafted petitions reviewed by attorney

2. Competitive Landscape



The 2026 map has two clear clusters: (a) **broad, English-first, generalist SaaS** (Boundless, SimpleCitizen, Lawfully) and (b) **premium AI-attorney hybrids** (LegalOS, Parley, Gale) that are essentially law firms with an AI layer, charging \$2,500–\$4,500 per case. **Nobody owns the Latino-first, mid-priced, compliance-monitor + attorney-handoff slot.** That is the wedge.

Critical insight: **Lawfully has 2.5M users** tracking USCIS cases — they own the *awareness* layer but monetize lightly through consultations. They are a potential acquisition target, distribution partner, or — if you're not careful — a competitor that ships the same wedge in 6 months.

3. SWOT — May 2026 environment

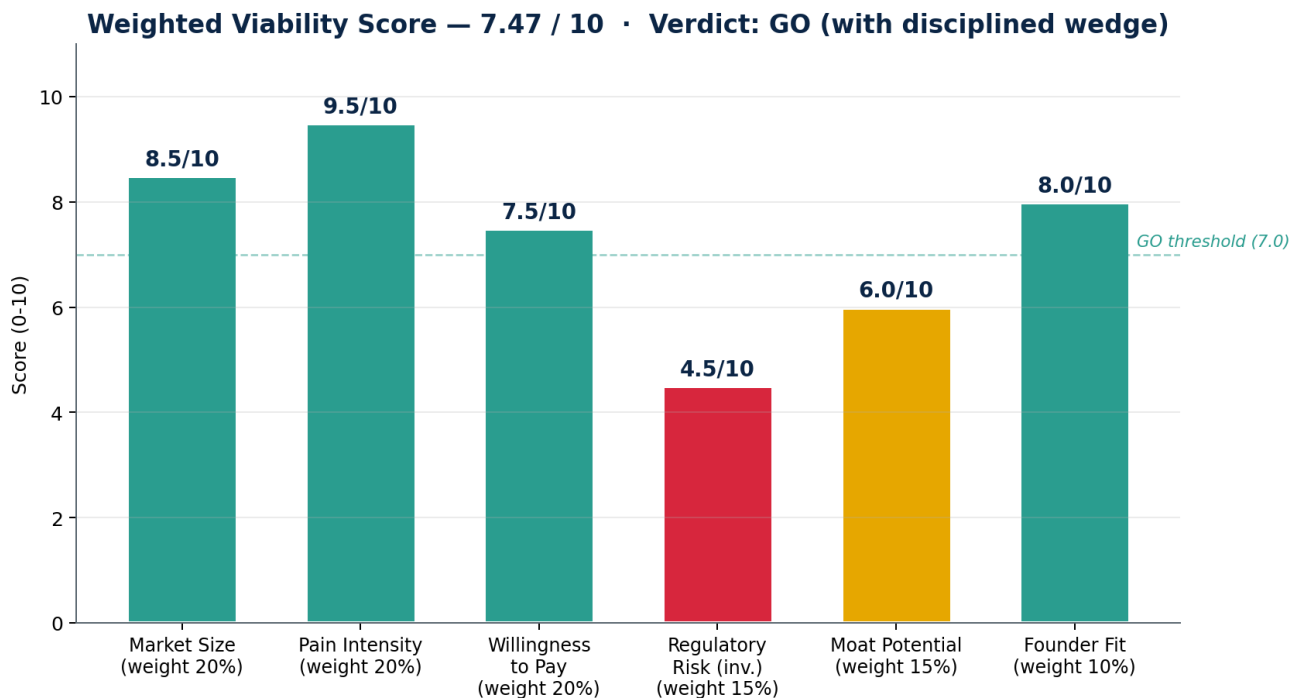
SWOT — Latino-first Immigration SaaS · May 2026 environment

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
• Founder-market fit (PT/ES native, expat lens) • AU+US founder split = global perspective • Underserved language stack (PT + ES first) • Anchored by real persona — Felipe-like users in millions • AI cost curve makes 10x cheaper unit economics possible	• Neither founder is a U.S. immigration attorney (UPL risk) • Regulated industry → slow legal & compliance setup • Trust deficit: immigrants historically defrauded by 'notarios' • Multi-language support adds product complexity • Customer acquisition into immigrant community is hard
OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
• Trump 2.0 enforcement → urgency + WTP at all-time high • 12M USCIS pending cases = massive anxiety surface • \$170B enforcement budget = more RFEs, more denials, more need for AI competitors (LegalOS, Parley, Gale) raising fast • Latino founders <2% of VC — narrative + thesis fit • AI cuts attorney prep time 20+ hrs → flat-fee disruption • Adjacent revenue: school enrollment, attorney referral fees	• ICE / DOJ scrutiny if perceived as helping 'overstayers' • UPL lawsuits (DoNotPay precedent) + state bar pressure • Lawfully owns the awareness layer (2.5M users) • Public charge rule expands → some products effectively banned • Florida SB 1718-type laws expand chilling effect

So-what implications

- **Strength → Action:** Lead with Portuguese; Boundless can't replicate fast.
- **Weakness → Mitigation:** Bring an immigration attorney on the cap table or as managing director from day 0.
- **Opportunity → Wedge:** Cohort 1 = Persona A look-alikes (B1/B2 → F1, FL+TX+NJ+MA Brazilians + Mexicans + Venezuelans).
- **Threat → Defense:** Move fast on UPL-safe architecture (forms + info, attorney-of-record handoff, never offer 'which visa is best' as legal advice).

4. Verdict — GO (with disciplined wedge)



Score: 7.48 / 10. Three forces converge to a GO. (1) Pain is at a generational peak — enforcement, denials, anxiety. (2) Founder-market fit is real — trilingual capability + immigrant lens that incumbents structurally lack. (3) AI cost curve makes a **1/10th-the-cost** attorney alternative finally credible.

*The 4.5/10 on **Regulatory Risk** is what keeps this from being a 9. UPL law, ICE/DOJ optics around 'helping overstayers,' and state-bar lawsuits (DoNotPay set the precedent) are existential, not minor. They are manageable if engineered for from day 0 — and fatal if bolted on later.*

5. Recommended Business Model

Pricing — Three tiers + Concierge

Recommended Pricing — Three-Tier Subscription + Concierge

BASE

Compliance Monitor

\$9 / mo

\$108 / yr

✓

Status dashboard

✓

Case + I-94 tracker

✓

Doc vault + reminders

✓

PT/ES/EN content

CORE

Pathway + Doc Prep

\$29 / mo

\$348 / yr

✓

Everything in Base

✓

Pathway recommender (AI)

✓

Form prep (I-539, I-765, I-20)

✓

Evidence checklists

✓

1 attorney check-in / yr

CONCIERGE

Attorney-Led Filing

\$1,499

per case (flat)

✓

Full case package + attorney of record

✓

Partner attorney network

✓

Premium processing assist

✓

Money-back on RFE-only denials

Why this structure works: Base (\$9/mo) is the cheapest legal peace-of-mind on the market — gets people through the door and collects compliance data. Core (\$29/mo) is where the real margin and the AI pathway recommender live. Concierge (\$1,499 flat per case, with attorney of record) replaces a \$3,500–\$10,000 attorney engagement at **1/3 to 1/7** the price — that’s the disruption story.

Unit economics (target, year 2)

Metric	Base	Core	Concierge
ARPU	\$108/yr	\$348/yr	\$1,499/case
Gross margin	85%	78%	55% (attorney rev share)
Blended CAC target	\$28	\$55	\$220
Payback (months)	3.1	1.9	Single-payment
Mix by year 2	55%	35%	10%
Blended ARPU	\$360	—	—

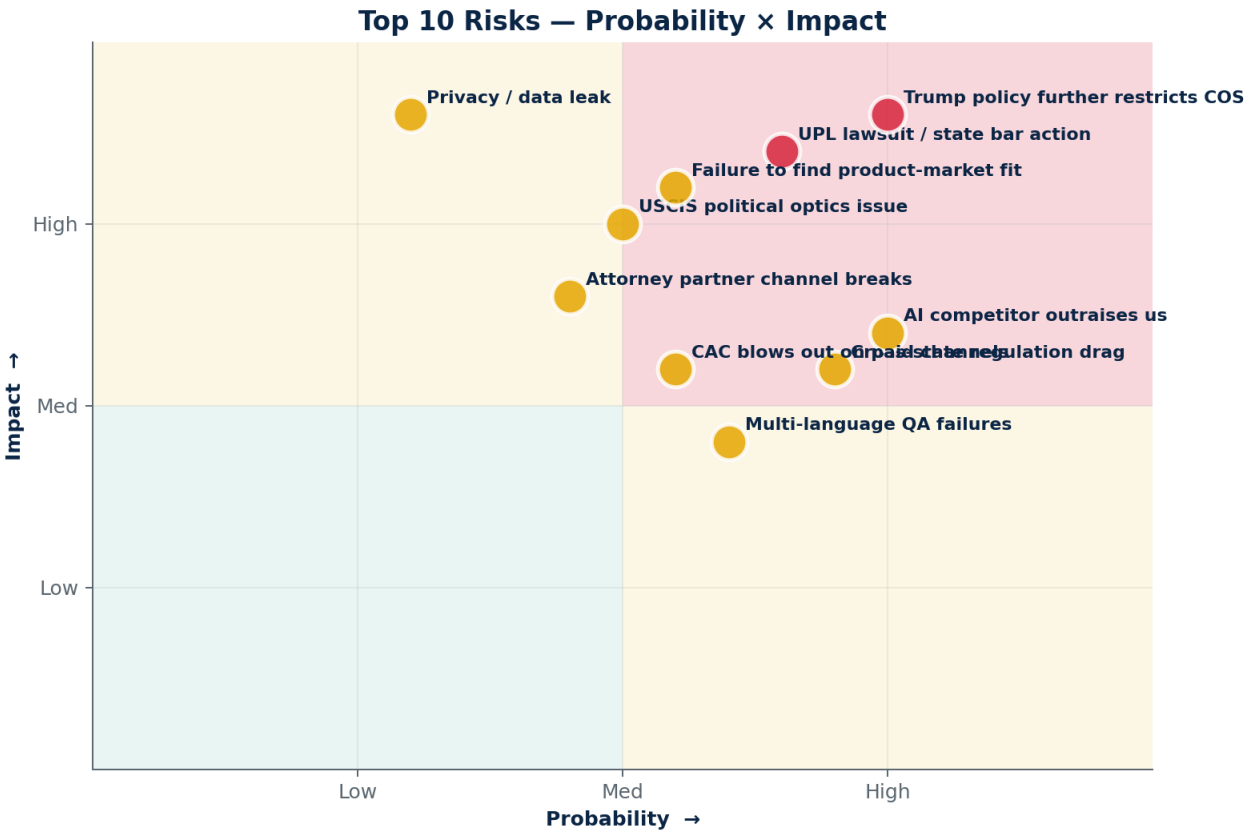
12-Month Go-To-Market Plan



UPL-safe legal architecture (non-negotiable)

- Page 10

6. Risks



The two red-zone risks — **UPL lawsuit** and **Trump policy further restricting change-of-status** — are the strategy-reset triggers. If either fires, the wedge (B1/B2 → F1 COS) has to shift toward employer-sponsored visas, consular processing prep, or relocation/'plan B' counsel.

What I'd validate in the next 14 days

When	Experiment	Success criterion
Day 1-3	Run 10 customer interviews	Persona A look-alikes via Brazilian FL WhatsApp groups + Mexican TX church network
Day 2-5	Stand up a landing page (PT+ES+EW)	Play Meta ad to FL/TX zips with Latino dominant. Success: ≥4% landing → email
Day 4-8	Recruit 1 attorney partner	Call 20 immigration attorneys in FL. Success: ≥1 LOI to be the attorney-of-record for
Day 6-10	Probe SEVP school referral	Reach out to 5 SEVP-certified schools in Broward & Miami-Dade. Success: ≥1 willing
Day 10-14	Pricing reaction tests	Run a Van Westendorp or paid-pre-order experiment on \$1,499 Concierge. Success

Sources

All major claims in this report can be traced to:

- DHS — Entry/Exit Overstay Report FY2024 (Sept 2025) — overstayer counts by country
- DHS news (Nov 2025) — "Cracks Down on Visa Abuse" — enforcement posture
- Migration Policy Institute (2025) — Brazilian immigrants in the U.S. demographics
- Pew Research Center (Oct 2025) — Key facts about U.S. Latinos
- Manifest Law / Modern Law Group (May 2026) — USCIS processing time trackers
- immi-usa.com — FY 2025 USCIS denial rates and processing times
- American Immigration Council — Mass Deportation report and SB 1718 litigation analysis
- Migration Policy Institute — Trump 2.0 first-year immigration policy analysis
- Wikipedia — Immigration policy of the second Trump administration
- USCIS Policy Manual — Vol. 2, Part A, Ch. 4 (period of authorized stay)
- PitchBook — Boundless Immigration company profile + Localize acquisition
- Boundless / SimpleCitizen / Borderwise / Lawfully — pricing pages and Trustpilot reviews
- Y Combinator — LegalOS, Parley, Gale company pages (Winter 2026 batch)
- Artificial Lawyer (Feb 2026) — AI legal startup coverage
- National Center for State Courts — UPL modernization white paper (Aug 2025)
- California State Bar — UPL guidance for immigration consultants (\$100K bond)
- Justice Dept. EOIR — Recognition & Accreditation Program (2025 update)
- Crunchbase + Harlem Capital — 2024 Diverse Founder Report (Latino VC funding share)
- USF / Tampa Bay (Nov 2024) — Impact of Florida SB 1718 on immigrants
- Lawfully — Product Hunt + App Store stats (2.5M users tracking)

This report is not legal advice. Felipe-equivalent users should retain a licensed U.S. immigration attorney before filing or changing status.